TIDYWELLS REFERENCE SHEET

Regulator Data Gotchas

Seven things that quietly break an analysis of public Canadian well data.

1. Leading zeros in IDs matter

A well or facility ID is text, not a number. Open a file in a spreadsheet and 0001234 becomes 1234, then joins fail or match the wrong record.

2. Licensed ≠ producing

A licence says a well may exist. Only a production report says it produced. Count producing wells from production rows, not from licence lists.

3. Monthly volume is not a rate

Divide by days in the month before comparing months. February is short, not broken.

4. Check the unit on every file

m^3, 10^3m^3, bbl, Mcf: the header tells you, the filename may not. Alberta and Saskatchewan (Petrinex) and BC (BCER) do not share a layout.

5. Prorated and estimated rows

Some volumes are allocated across wells rather than metered one by one. Treat single-well precision with care.

6. Regulators restate months

The first number published for a month can change later. Keep dated copies of what you downloaded so you can see what moved.

7. Totals differ between sources

A product definition (for example conventional volumetrics only) changes the total. When two sources disagree, compare definitions before assuming an error.

General cautions drawn from the public file layouts. Tidywells is not affiliated with any regulator; this is not legal or investment advice.